



I'm a 16 year old person living in Denmark. I'm born in Denmark, but my parents are from Lesotho. I just finished primary school in Denmark and am now considering what my next step should be. I'm fluent in danish.

What educational path would you recommend for me?

Thanks for sharing that about yourself—it's great that you're thinking seriously about your future at this stage. Since you've just finished primary school in Denmark, your next step would typically be choosing a **youth education program** ("ungdomsuddannelse"), which usually starts around age 16. There are a few main options, and the best one for you depends on your interests, goals, and the kind of career or further education you might want later.

## Main Educational Paths in Denmark After Primary School

### 1. Gymnasiale Uddannelser (Upper Secondary Education) – Academic Path

These are academically focused and prepare you for university.

- **STX (Studentereksamen):** General academic education with a wide range of subjects. Great if you enjoy humanities, languages, social sciences, or natural sciences.
- **HHX (Higher Commercial Examination):** Focus on business, economics, and international trade.
- **HTX (Higher Technical Examination):** Emphasis on science, technology, and innovation.
- **HF (Higher Preparatory Examination):** Shorter (2 years), more flexible, often for those who didn't go the traditional route or want a second chance.

#### Recommended if:

You're aiming for university or want to keep many doors open. STX is the most general, while HTX/HHX are great if you already like science or business.

### 2. Erhvervsuddannelser (VET – Vocational Education and Training)

This is a more hands-on education that combines school and apprenticeship (praktik) in a real job.

- Fields include healthcare, IT, mechanics, construction, hospitality, etc.
- You earn a wage during your apprenticeship.

#### Recommended if:

You want to enter the job market faster or prefer practical, real-world experience over academic study.

### 3. Kombineret ungdomsuddannelse (KUU) or EGU

For those who aren't quite ready for the other paths or need more support.

### Recommended if:

You want a gentler introduction to education or have had challenges in school and need something more tailored.

---

## How to Choose?

Here are some questions to ask yourself:

- Do I enjoy academic subjects and schoolwork? → Consider **STX, HHX, HTX, or HF**.
  - Do I want to work with my hands, learn a trade, and get a job soon? → **Vocational education (EUD)**.
  - Am I still unsure and need more time or support to figure it out? → Look into **KUU** or **EGU**.
- 

## Personal Factors to Consider

- Being fluent in Danish is a big advantage—you'll do well in any path you choose.
  - Your background from Lesotho could also be a strength, especially in global studies, language, international business, or social work.
  - Denmark's education system is flexible, and you can often switch tracks or go from vocational to academic paths later.
- 

## Final Advice

- Visit open houses at local gymnasiums and vocational schools.
- Talk to a **UU-vejleder** (youth education advisor) at your school or kommune—they can help you map your options.
- Try to do a **brobygning** or **praktik** (trial course or internship) if you're unsure.

If you tell me more about your interests (subjects you like, whether you enjoy school, or what kind of jobs you imagine doing), I can give you a more personalized recommendation.